STUDENT WORKSHEET #1

Health Claim Verification Lab

Hands-On Exercise: Testing Claims & Spotting AI Citations

Student Name: _____ **Date:** _____ **Class Period:** _____

Part 1: Step-by-Step Claim Verification

Step 1: Input Claim into Verification Tool

Find a viral health claim online (or use a prompt assigned by your teacher) and paste it into the search box.

[Write down the viral claim you entered here]

Step 2: Examine the Evidence Card

Does the tool find matching peer-reviewed studies in PubMed or WHO? Does the clinical consensus Agree, Disagree, or Uncertainty?

[Summarize the evidence card verdict]

Step 3: Grade Source Reliability

Assign a source score based on publisher background, peer-review status, and conflict of interest flags.

[Source Grade: A / B / C / F — Explain why]

Part 2: Fake Citation Spotter Exercise

Sample Ad Claim to Audit:

"Clinical study by Dr. J. Smith et al. (2023) in the Journal of Biological Wellness (Vol 14, PMID: 9988211) proves detox tea boosts metabolism by 400%!"

Your Audit Task: Search PubMed for PMID 9988211 or the journal title.

☐ Study Found ☐ Study Fake / Hallucinated

Part 3: Student Reflection & Discovery Space

Reflection Prompt:

What surprised you most about how easy it is for AI search engines or online influencers to generate fake citations that look real? How will this change how you search for health topics in the future?

Summary: Checklist for Future Searches

Before believing any medical claim online, make sure you:

- Copy the cited study title directly into **PubMed.gov**.
- Check if the authors are affiliated with real university medical centers.
- Watch out for emotional trigger words like *"miracle," "secret,"* or *"suppressed."*
- Consult a real healthcare professional before changing treatments.